HHH-C-571F
September 23, 1985
SUPERSEDING
HHH-C-571E
November 21, 1977

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

COFFEE

This specification is approved by the U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA) for use by all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for coffee for the use of all Federal agencies.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Types. Coffee shall be of the following types, as specified (see 6.1):

Type I - Green, whole bean

A. Brazils
B. Columbian Excelso
C. Milds (other than Columbian Excelso)
D. Robustas

Type II - Roasted, whole bean

A. From Type I - A
B. A blend from any combination of Types I-A, I-B, and I-C, as specified
C. A blend from any combination of Type I

Type III - Roasted, ground

A. From Type II - A
B. From Type II - B
C. From Type II - C

FSC 8955

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1.2.2 Styles.

Style 1 - Regular
Style 2 - Decaffeinated

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government publications. The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications

TT-C-495	Coatings, Exterior, for Tinned Food Cans
PPP-B-636	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard
PPP-C-29	Canned Subsistence Items, Packaging and Packing Of

Federal Standard

FED-STD-123	Marking for Shipment (Civil Agencies)

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal specifications, standards, and commercial item descriptions as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, and Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions. The Index, which includes cumulative bimonthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal specifications and commercial item descriptions required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from General Services Administration Business Service Centers in Boston, MA; New York, NY; Philadelphia, PA; Washington, DC; Atlanta, GA; Chicago, IL; Kansas City, MO; Fort Worth, TX; Denver, CO; San Francisco, CA; Los Angeles, CA; and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal standardization documents and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications

MIL-L-1497	Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items
MIL-L-35078	Loads, Unit, Preparation of Semiperishable Subsistence Items, General Specification for

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Military Standards

MIL-STD-105	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129	Marking for Shipment and Storage

(Copies of military specifications and standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

Laws and Regulations

U.S. Department of Health and Human Services

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations
Promulgated Thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

U.S. Department of Agriculture

U.S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Director, Market Research and Development Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

(The Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) and the Federal Register (FR) are for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402. When indicated, reprints of certain regulations may be obtained from the Federal Agency responsible for issuance thereof.)

Defense Personnel Support Center

Procedure for Testing and Certificating of Green Coffee for Use by Contractors in Roasting and Grinding Coffee for the Armed Services of the U.S. Against Specifications of the Defense Personnel Support Center by the National Coffee Association of the U.S.A.

(Copies may be obtained from Defense Personnel Support Center, Directorate of Subsistence, ATTN: DPSC-SPP, 2800 South 20th St., Philadelphia, PA 19101.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

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Association of Official Analytical Chemists (AOAC)

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, 1111 North 19th Street, Suite 210, Arlington, VA 22209.)

New York Coffee, Sugar, and Cocoa Exchange

New York Coffee, Sugar, and Cocoa Exchange Standard

(Application for copies should be addressed to the New York Coffee, Sugar, and Cocoa Exchange, 4 World Trade Center, 8th Floor, New York, NY 10048.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Association, Inc., Traffic Department, 1616 P Street N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1160, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

(Technical society and technical association documents are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Type I, green, whole bean. Only those lots or chops of green coffees certified as to growth, quality, and grade shall be used for production of roasted coffee. Green bean coffee shall be stored in a dry location having free circulation of air. The area shall be free from insects, rodents, foreign odors, and any other source of contamination. Only green coffee from sound bags shall be processed. Each growth shall be grouped by chop marks, segregated from the supplier's commercial supply and prominently marked by a card or sign identifying it as coffee to be used on Government contracts. Original bags, torn in transit from the country of origin, may be mended provided the top, bottom, and side seams are intact. Coffee in mended bags shall be comparable with coffee of the same chop from sound bags.

3.1.1 Type I-A, Brazils. This type shall be bourbon, medium to good bean,

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good roast, strictly soft, solid bean, greenish color, and good cup quality. The grade shall be Brazil 4's, or 3's and 4's, and in accordance with the physical grading of the New York Coffee, Sugar, and Cocoa Exchange Standard. Such green coffee beans shall be shipped from the ports of Santos, Parangua, Angra dos Reis, Rio de Janeiro, or Niteroi, Brazil. The descriptive terms "good cup quality" and "strictly soft", as utilized herein, shall be interpreted as establishing the same quality standards as are established by like terms in describing Santos 4's, or 3's and 4's, green bean coffee.

3.1.2 Type I-B, Colombian Excelso. Green whole bean coffees of this type shall be of the current crop, of usual good quality and of the following designations:

1. Medellin
2. Manizales
3. Armenia
4. Girardot
5. Sevilla
6. Bogota

3.1.3 Type I-C, Milds (other than Colombian Excelso). Green, whole bean coffees of this type shall be of the current crop, of usual good quality, and of the following designations, as specified (see 6.1):

1. Prime washed Guatemalan
2. Prime washed Mexican
3. Central Standard washed Salvadoran
4. Fine washed Tachira Venezuelan
5. Fine washed Kona

3.1.4 Type I-D, Robustas. Green whole coffee beans of this type shall be of the current crop, no lower than fair average quality, and of the following designations:

1. Uganda Standard
2. Ambriz AA's
3. Ivory Coast Superior

3.1.5 Evaluation of green coffee for Military agencies. Characteristics of palatability and other requirements as pertains to individual chops of certified green coffee shall be evaluated and coded by a designated group of Government coffee experts. Contractors shall be informed of these evaluations and instructed as to the formulation of the blend (see 6.1). Coffee so coded may be used for filling any contracts for Military agencies. In case of Style 2, decaffeinated, the green coffee shall be evaluated before and after decaffeination.

3.1.6 Certification of green coffee for Military agencies. Requirement for testing and certificating green coffee shall be in accordance with the

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Procedure for Testing and Certificating of Green Coffee for Use by Contractors in Roasting and Grinding Coffee for the Armed Services of the U.S. Against Specifications of the Defense personnal Support Center by the National Coffee Association of U.S.A.

3.2 Type II, roasted, whole bean. The green coffee shall be thoroughly cleaned, roasted without the addition of water except in sufficient quantity to check roasting process, and thoroughly stoned. The coffee shall have typical quality, body, acidity, flavor, and aroma for the type.

3.2.1 Type II-A. This type shall be Type I-A, roasted in accordance with 3.2 and 3.4.

3.2.2 Type II-B. This type shall be a blend of any combination of Type I-A, I-B and I-C in proportions as specified (see 6.1), and shall be roasted in accordance with 3.2 and 3.4.

3.2.3 Type II-C. This type shall be a blend of any combination of Types I-A, I-B, I-C, and I-D in proportions as specified (see 6.1), and shall be roasted in accordance with 3.2 and 3.4.

3.3 Type III, roasted, ground. The coffee shall be ground in accordance with 3.5.

3.3.1 Type III-A. This type shall be ground from whole bean Type II-A.

3.3.2 Type III-B. This type shall be ground from whole bean Type II-B.

3.3.3 Type III-C. This type shall be ground from whole bean Type II-C.

3.4 Processing. Before the contractor proceeds to process approved green coffee for the Government, all residue of previous production runs will be cleared out from production equipment to be used in the entire processing. Green coffee that is not contained in original bags, which does not bear the proper lot or chop marks, that is wet, moldy, or otherwise adversely affected, shall be eliminated from production. Green coffee that has spilled around the dump hopper, mixer, or blender, shall not be placed into production unless such coffee is clean and sound. In addition, green bean, whole bean roasted, or roasted ground coffee that has been spilled or dropped to the floor during processing at the roasters, stoners, bucket elevators, grinders, weighing equipment, or vacuum sealers, shall not be placed back into production. The green and roasted coffee shall be cleaned during processing to remove foreign materials such as strings, dirt, stones, wood, glass, metal objects, etc. The green coffees shall be "dumped" in the proportions stated in 3.2.2 or 3.2.3, as applicable. The green coffees shall be thoroughly mixed, and roasted throughout to a color matching the Government standard (see 3.4.2). Only such quantity of roasted whole bean coffee may be carried over from one production day to the next as is normally accommodated within the pipeline and can be safeguarded againt commingling with unauthorized blends. The roasted whole

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bean coffee shall not be held more than 18 hours prior to grinding and shall be packaged within 2 hours after grinding. Roasted whole bean coffee shall be ground on roller type grinders. All coffee grinders and ground coffee storage hoppers shall be thoroughly cleaned of all residue of previous grind, prior to each day's production run.

3.4.1 Equipment and production runs. Any specific requirement pertaining to coffee processing equipment and usage thereof shall be as specified in the purchase document. The processing equipment shall be kept clear of commercial coffee during the processing of coffee for the Government.

3.4.2 Color standard. The contractor will be provided with a sample of roasted whole bean coffee representing the color to which production roasts of coffee must conform.

3.4.3 Roasted whole bean or ground coffee. Roasted whole bean or ground coffee, packed in bags or cartons, shall be shipped as soon as possible after roasting and in no case later than 72 hours. Vacuum packed ground coffee shall be shipped not later than 15 days after packaging.

3.4.4 Coffee blend. Roasted and ground coffee (Type III-B or III-C) shall be produced from a blend, by weight, of green coffees, as specified (see 3.2.2, 3.2.3, 3.3.2, 3.3.3, and 6.1).

3.5 Finished product (granular size of grind). The grind shall be of the granular size as given in Table I and specified in 6.1. Moisture content (loss on drying) of roasted and ground coffee shall not exceed 2.75 percent in the packaged item. For Style 2, the caffeine content shall not exceed 0.07 percent on a dry basis in the packaged item. For Style 2 only, the moisture content shall not exceed 6.00 percent in the package.

TABLE I. Standard grinds for coffee 1/

	Percent on 16 mesh sieve	Percent through 30 mesh sieve	
Grind designation	Maximum	Minimum	Maximum
Regular	33	9	15
Drip or universal	7	16	24
Fine	0	25	40

1/ The sieves referred to in the above table are U.S. Standard sieves (or equivalent) (see 4.6.1).

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3.5.1 Palatability. Delivery samples of the finished product shall be cup tested by a panel of experienced USDA coffee specialists. Coffee shall possess the flavor and aroma of the blend procured. Coffee which passes the sensory tests shall conform to all other requirements as specified herein.

3.5.2 Production runs. A minimum time length for production runs, when required, shall be as specified in the purchase document.

3.6 Plant qualification. The product shall be prepared, processed, and packaged in establishments meeting the requirements of Title 21, Code of Federal Regulations, Part 110: Current Good Manufacturing Practice in Manufacture, Processing, Packaging or Holding of Human Foods; and the plant sanitation requirements of the appropriate Government inspection agency.

3.7 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all requirements of this document. The contractor shall assure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

4.2 Inspection and certification. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of supervision necessary to assure compliance with the requirements of this document.

4.3 Preacceptance inspection (plant sanitation inspection). The product shall be rejected if not prepared, processed, and packaged in plants meeting the requirements of 3.6.

4.4 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.4.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1 above, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified or qualified in this document or applicable purchase documents.

4.4.1.1 Green bean. Each individual lot or chop shall be sampled.

4.4.1.2 Roasted whole bean and roasted ground. Representative samples shall be taken at the roasting plant during processing and on or before delivery to carrier to determine compliance with the requirements.

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4.4.2 In-process examination (except as pertains to color of roasted whole bean). In-process examination shall be performed (except the color for roasted whole bean) to determine compliance with specified requirements in 3.1, 3.4, and 3.4.1 as concerns procedures and controls. Records shall be maintained reflecting the quantities (in bags) of individual lots or chops of green coffees used on each day's production and the pounds of roasted and ground coffee produced from a week's run of green coffee. In addition, such records shall include the formulation of chops or lots of green coffees on a batch "dump" basis. Any nonconformance found during process examination or as shown on the aforementioned records shall be cause for elimination of the involved coffee (at the applicable stage of processing), or rejection of the finished product made therefrom. In the event that "nonconforming" coffee has been mixed with "approved" coffee at any stage of production, such quantity of mixed coffee shall be rejected.

4.4.2.1 Examination for color of roasted whole bean. Roasted whole bean coffee shall be examined to determine conformance to 3.4.2 as pertains to color of roast. The sample unit for examination shall be approximately 1/2 pound of roasted whole bean coffee taken from a single roast or in the case of a continuous roaster, taken at any one time during the evacuation of coffee from the roaster. The lot size shall be expressed in terms of pounds. The sample size shall be the number of sample units indicated by inspection level S-2 applied against the number of pounds of roasted whole bean coffee being processed. - The acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 1.0, expressed as percent defective. Determinations shall be accomplished by (1) comparing the color of the production sample, as is, with that of the Government standard, and (2) comparing the color of a ground production sample with that of a sample of ground Government standard. Each sample of roasted whole bean coffee (production and standard), shall be ground to the same degree of fineness by the same grinder. A defect shall be scored for a production sample unit not conforming to either the whole bean color standard or ground bean color standard or both. Examination records shall be maintained in the same manner as that for the examination of the end item.

4.4.3 Examination of containers. The product shall comply with the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers and the requirements of this document.

4.4.4 End item inspection.

4.4.4.1 Filled and sealed 20-pound can vacuum. The filled and sealed 20-pound cans shall be examined for the defects listed in Table II. The lot size shall be expressed in cans. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed can. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL shall be 2.5, expressed in terms of percent defective.

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TABLE II. Examination of 20-pound can vacuum

Category	Defect
Major	
102	Less than 25 inch vacuum (17 kPa pressure) 1/

1/ Use standard puncture-type vacuum gauge. Alternatively, observe the vacuum reading on can seamer for first sample taken. Immediately determine vacuum by using puncture type gauge. Vacuum readings from the seamer gauge may be used for the remainder of the sample units provided the puncture-type vacuum gauge reading is not less than 25 inches and the seamer gauge displays a reading equal to or greater than 25 inches.

4.4.4.2 - Net weight examination. The net weight of the filled and sealed containers shall be examined for the defects listed in Table III. The lot size shall be expressed in cans. The sample unit shall be one filled can. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL shall be 2.5, expressed in terms of percent defective.

TABLE III. Examination for net weight 1/ 2/

Category	Defects
Minor	
201	Net weight more than 5.0 percent under specified weight (container 1 pound or less)
202	Net weight more than 2.0 percent under specified weight (container more than 1 pound but not more than 10 pounds)
203	Net weight more than 1 percent under specified weight (container more than 10 pounds)

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TABLE III. Examination for net weight 1/ 2/ - Continued

1/ Lot shall be rejected if sample data indicate lot average net weight is less than specified net weight.
2/ Report results to nearest 0.1 ounce for all cans except 20-pound cans. Report results to nearest ounce for 20-pound cans.

4.4.4.3 Examination for palatability of finished product. The finished product shall be examined for the defect listed in Table IV. The lot size shall be expressed in pounds. The sample unit shall be one pound from a can. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the AQL shall be 1.5, expressed in terms of percent defective.

TABLE IV. Examination for palatability of finished product 1/

Category	Defect
Major	
103	Palatability of blend not characteristic of specified blend

1/ Make one determination per sample unit (see 3.5.1). Nonconformance shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.4.4.4 Examination for particle size of product. The product shall be examined for the defect listed in Table V. The lot size shall be expressed in terms of pounds. The sample unit shall be one pound from a can. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the AQL shall be 1.5, expressed in terms of percent defective.

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TABLE V. Examination for particle size of product 1/ 2/

Category	Defect
Minor	
206	Particle size not as required

1/ See 4.6 for sieving procedure. Make one determination per sample unit.

2/ Presence of foreign material (e.g., filth, insects, metal, wood, paint, glass, etc.) shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.4.4.5 Flexible package leakage testing. The filled and sealed flexible packages shall be tested for leaks as specified in 4.4.4.11 for the requirements in 5.1.2. The lot size shall be expressed in flexible packages. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed package. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL, expressed in terms of percent defective, shall be 0.65. Any nonconformance shall be scored as a major defect.

4.4.4.6 Examination of cans (level A other than 20-pound cans). Examination for external condition, can opening operation (when applicable), vacuum, and exterior can coating shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of PPP-C-29, except that the defect applicable to slip cover reclosure in the external examination of can shall not apply. In lieu thereof, the following defects shall apply: Major - Plastic reclosure lid missing, torn, or not tight fitting. Minor - Nontransparent reclosure lid affixed to label end of can. In addition, for can vacuum examination, the vacuum shall be determined within one minute after can closure.

4.4.4.6.1 Twenty-pound cans. Examination of the 20-pound cans shall be made to determine whether the weight of product, construction, tinplate exterior coating and vacuum comply with the requirements of 5.1.1.2. Defects shall be in accordance with the applicable tables of Section 4. Examination for external condition shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of PPP-C-29.

4.4.4.7 Examination of can label for Military agencies. Examination shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-L-1497.

4.4.4.7.1 Examination of labeling for flexible packages. Labeling which is incorrect, illegible, missing or not in compliance with the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act shall be cause for rejection (see 5.4.2.2).

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4.4.4.8 Examination of shipping container (1-, 2-, or 3-pound cans). Examination of the filled and closed shipping containers shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions in PPP-C-29. It shall be a major defect if reinforcement with nonmetallic strapping or tape is not used, when applicable.

4.4.4.9 Examination of shipping containers (20-pound cans). Examination of the filled and closed shipping containers shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions in the appendix of PPP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be included in the examination: Major - Markings missing, incorrect or illegible; Reinforcement with nonmetallic strapping or tape not used, when applicable; Minor - Arrangement or number of cans not as specified. When packing in accordance with 5.2.3.3 is specified, only the defects pertaining to markings and arrangement of cans shall be applicable.

4.4.4.10 Examination of unit loads. Unit loads shall be examined in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-L-35078.

4.4.4.11 Examination of flexible packages for leakage. The hermetic seal of the filled and closed flexible packages shall be examined for leakage by submerging the package in water inside a vacuum desiccator, Mead Tester, or equivalent device and drawing a vacuum of 10 inches of mercury (67.2 kPa) for at least 30 seconds. A leak is indicated by a steady progression of bubbles. Isolated bubbles caused by air entrapped in the seam are not considered as signs of leakage.

4.5 Testing of finished product.

4.5.1 Testing for moisture content. The finished product shall be tested for moisture content in accordance with 4.6. Style 2 product content shall be in accordance with 4.6. The sample for testing shall be a one-pound composite of ground coffee derived from the number of cans indicated by inspection level S-2. Lot size shall be expressed in cans. Test results for moisture shall be reported to the nearest 0.01 percent and a result exceeding 2.75 percent for Style 1, or 6.00 percent for Style 2 shall be cause for rejection of the lot. Test results for caffeine shall be reported to the nearest 0.01 percent and a result exceeding 0.07 percent shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.5.2 Testing of cans. Cans shall be tested as shown in Table VI. Requirements for test characteristics listed below are applicable to the lot average of bodies and ends. A test failure shall indicate unacceptable cans and use of such shall be cause for rejection of the involved end item.

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TABLE VI. Testing of cans 1/

Component	Sample unit	Lot size expressed in	Inspection level	Characteristic	Results Reported	Test ref and rqmt para
Cans	One can w/lid or 4 by 4 inch panel w/ends for 20-pound cans	Cans	S-1	Tinplate	Nearest 0.01 pound/ base box	4.6.2.2 5.1.1

1/ Tests for can coating (when required), and can labeling shall be performed on the same cans submitted for tinplate.

4.6 Examination and test methods. Examination and test procedures which differ from those specified herein, unless otherwise excepted, may be used by the contractor if they provide a quality assurance equivalent to that specified. If the Government contracting officer determines that such procedures and controls do not provide, as a minimum, such quality assurance, the contractor will use the procedures set forth herein. In case of dispute as to examination or test results, the procedures specified herein will govern.

4.6.1 Examination procedures.

4.6.1.1 Granular size. Granular size of roasted and ground coffee shall be determined by agitating a 100 gram sample of ground coffee on a shaker containing sieves in the following order from top to bottom:

Nos. 16 and 30 U.S. Standard sieves or equivalent plus a collecting pan on the bottom. After agitating for five minutes, weigh quantity of coffee retained on U.S. No. 16 sieve and weigh quantity of coffee contained in the collecting pan.

4.6.2 Test procedures.

4.6.2.1 Chemical analyses. Chemical analyses shall be made in accordance with the following methods from the Official Methods of Analysis of the

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Association of Official Analytical Chemists.

Test	Chapter and Section	Method
Moisture (Loss on Drying)	Coffee and Tea; Roasted Coffee	Vacuum Oven Method I
For Style 2 only:		
Caffeine in Roasted Coffee	Coffee and Tea; Roasted Coffee	Chromatographic Spectrophotometric Method

4.6.2.2 Tin coating weights. Tin coating weights shall be determined as specified in PPP-C-29.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation (Type III coffee only). The coffee shall be preserved in accordance with level A or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A. Coffee, in units of 1, 2, 3, and 20 pounds, as specified (see 6.1) shall be packaged in acccordance with 5.1.1.1 or 5.1.1.2, as applicable for the size specified.

5.1.1.1 One-, 2-, or 3-pound vacuum-packed units. Coffee, in units of 1, 2, and 3 pounds shall be unit packed in accordance with PPP-C-29, with the following exception: a 603 by 608 can may be used in lieu of 603 by 700 for 3 pounds of coffee; 1- and 2-pound cans shall be Style 1 or 1b; 3-pound cans shall be Style 1. The cans shall have a beaded body or shall be of sufficient base weight and temper to withstand the required vacuum.

5.1.1.1.1 Plastic lid. When specified (see 6.1), the cans shall have a close fitting plastic lid affixed securely to one end of the can. If the plastic lid is not transparent, it shall be affixed to the nonlabeled end of the can. The plastic lids shall meet the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

5.1.1.2 Twenty-pound vacuum packaged unit. Twenty pounds of the coffee shall be filled into a can having the approximate dimensions of 9 3/8 by 9 3/8 by 13 3/4 inches. The cans shall have soldered side seams and compound-lined, double-seamed ends, soldered top and bottom or unlined, single or double-seamed ends, soldered top and bottom. Alternatively, the can shall have a welded side seam with compound-lined, double-seamed top and bottom ends. The cans shall be made throughout from not less than commercial 0.25 pound per base box electrolytic tinplate (see 4.6.2.2). The can shall have a sufficient

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base plate weight and temper to withstand the required vacuum and to protect the product during shipment and storage. The exterior of the can shall be coated overall with a coating conforming to Type I or, when specified, Type III of TT-C-495. The top of the can shall be provided with a cover not less than 6 3/16 inches in diameter, compound-lined and double-seamed in position. Alternatively, the cover shall be a minimum of 6 3/16 inches in diameter, compound-lined and rolled or clinched over a flared flange opening in the can, forming a joint inclining outward approximately 4° or 20° from the vertical. The top of all cans and the neck or flange of the opening shall be of a one-piece construction. A hermetic seal shall be effected after a sufficient vacuum has been drawn on the product, so that when tested within one minute from the instant of closure, a minimum vacuum reading of 25 inches of mercury (17 kPa pressure) shall be obtained. A correction of 1 inch of mercury shall be added to the reading for each 1000 feet above sea level at which the determination is made.

5.1.2 Level C. Commercial unit packing in cans or hermetically sealed, gas flushed flexible unit packs shall be acceptable. In the event a nontransparent reclosure lid is applied to the can, it shall be affixed to the nonlabeled end of the can. The hermetically sealed flexible unit pack shall not leak when examined in accordance with 4.4.4.11.

5.2 Packing (Type III coffee only). The coffee shall be packed in accordance with levels A, B or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A.

5.2.1.1 One-, 2-, and 3-pound cans. The 1-, 2-, and 3-pound cans shall be packed in accordance with the level A requirements of PPP-C-29.

5.2.1.2 Twenty-pound cans. Two 20-pound cans shall be packed on end in a snug-fitting fiberboard box constructed and closed in accordance with Style SFF, V2s of PPP-B-636. The shipping container shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive, reinforced tape. There shall be one lengthwise band and two girthwise bands, with the girthwise bands being centered over the cans.

5.2.2 Level B.

5.2.2.1 One-, 2-, and 3-pound cans. The 1-, 2-, and 3-pound cans shall be packed in accordance with the level B requirements of PPP-C-29.

5.2.2.2 Twenty-pound cans. Two 20-pound cans shall be packed on end in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with Style SFF, V3c, V3s, or V4s, of PPP-B-636. The shipping container shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive, reinforced tape. There shall be one lengthwise band and two girthwise bands, with the girthwise bands being centered over the cans.

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5.2.3 Level C.

5.2.3.1 One-, 2-, and 3-pound cans. The 1-, 2-, and 3-pound cans shall be packed in accordance with the level C requirements of PPP-C-29.

5.2.3.2 Twenty-pound cans. Two 20-pound cans shall be packed on end in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed, and closed in accordance with Styles RSC or SFF, Type CF or SF, Class domestic, Method II closure of PPP-B-636.

5.2.3.3 Flexible unit packs and filter cans. Flexible unit packs and filter cans shall be packed in accordance with the Uniform Freight Classification of the National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable.

5.3 Unit loads. When specified (see 6.1), the coffee, packed as specified in 5.2, shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified.

5.4 Labeling and marking.

5.4.1 Civil agencies.

5.4.1.1 Cans and flexible unit packs. Any labeling that complies with the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder is acceptable, and such other information as specified by individual agencies.

5.4.1.2 Shipping containers. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1), shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with FED-STD-123 and such other information as specified by individual agencies.

5.4.2 Military agencies.

5.4.2.1 Cans. Cans shall be labeled in accordance with MIL-L-1497 except that the name shall appear as follows:

COFFEE, ROASTED, GROUND
UNIVERSAL GRIND

Lithographing, printing, or hand stamping shall be used. Embossing and use of paper labels will not be acceptable.

5.4.2.2 Flexible unit packs. Each flexible unit pack shall be printed on one face in permanent ink in bold face legible type in letters not less than 5/16 inch high with the following information:

NSN
Nomenclature
Date packaged (mo/yr)
Net weight

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The nomenclature shall be as follows:

COFFEE, ROASTED, GROUND
UNIVERSAL GRIND

5.4.2.3 Shipping containers. Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. The nomenclature shall be as follows:

COFFEE, ROASTED, GROUND
UNIVERSAL GRIND

5.4.2.4 Unit loads. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents.

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Type required.
c. When Type II-B is required specify proportion of combination (see 3.2.2 and 3.4).
d. Blend required (see 3.1.3, 3.1.5, 3.2.2, 3.2.3, 3.3.2, 3.3.3, and 3.4.4).
e. Granular size of grind (see 3.5).
f. When preacceptance inspection is requested (see 4.3).
g. Selection of applicable levels of preservation and packing for Type III required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
h. When the cans are required to have a close fitting plastic lid (see 5.1.1.1.1.).
i. Type and class of unit load, when unit loading is required (see 5.3).
j. When other than specified marking is required (see 5.4.1.2).

6.2 Contractor's inspection. The contractor should be required to assure that the product conforms with the document prior to submission to the Government for final inspection.

6.3 Destination inspection (Civil agencies only). When the finished product has been inspected and passed at point other than destination, the contract should require that the product be inspected at destination for condition and quantity only.

6.4 Level of pack. Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling, and storage of the specified item being procured, the contracting officer should select the appropriate level of pack

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in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15/NAVSUPINST 4030.28/ AFT 71.06/MCO 4030.33A/DLAR 4145.7, as applicable.

6.5 Special operations packing. Packing specified in 5.2.2.2 is intended for transfer at sea operations or specific overseas operations.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review Activities:

Army - MD, TS
Navy - MC, MS
DP - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

USDA - AMS, FQA
HHS - NIH
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

Army - GL

Project No. 8955-0055

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